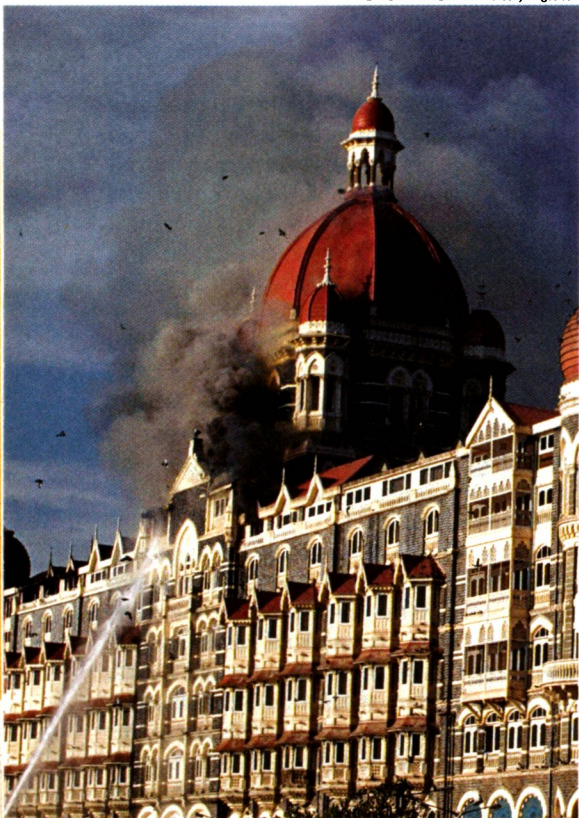


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26/11 EXPOSED OUR POORLY COORDINATED COUNTER-TERRORISM EFFORTS

philosophy of counter-terrorism has led to one of the most important changes in the long history of counter-terrorism in the UK. The need to be able to intervene at all stages of terrorist planning, and to do so in a way that leaves open the option of trying the terrorists in a court, has fundamentally changed the relationship between the intelligence agencies and law enforcement. They now need to work together, sharing information and agreeing to joint strategies for dealing with major investigations. In many ways this is revolutionary, and in some places will be difficult to achieve because of current structures, laws, working practices and, yes, at times rivalries. These must all be challenged and put aside in the interests of protecting the public and defeating terrorists.

However, the change in counter-terrorist methodology goes beyond the need to save lives. Despite the assertions of some sceptics, modern terrorism does pose a strategic threat to democracies, and indeed to the established world order. The impact of 9/11 has been self evident, and but for

some excellent transnational counter-terrorism, would not have been unique. Just think what the impact would have been had the 2006 plot to blow up Trans Atlantic airliners using liquid bombs been successful? What if thousands of people had died in those planned attacks? What would have been the impact on the world economy? The aviation industry would have been devastated, and there has been speculation as to what the effect would have been on relations between various communities in the UK. Who can say what the wider geopolitical fallout would have been?

The upshot of all this is that counter-terrorists need to adapt. There is no single prescription that will fit every nation or every situation. Earlier this year at the INDIA TODAY Conclave in Delhi, I was asked by an Indian MP if I had any advice following the terrible attacks in Mumbai the previous November. I replied that it would be presumptuous for me or anyone else to offer advice without the benefit of having a full and detailed picture of what had happened. I did, however, say that there were some basic questions that should be asked as we prepare our counter-terrorist plans.

First, are we sure that all the agencies involved are totally coordinated in their response? Do they train and exercise together? Are the command protocols absolutely clear? Who is in charge? I can only speak for the UK, but in July 2005 the fact that all the emergency services had trained together for several years greatly helped the response to the attacks on the Underground.

Second, are the arrangements for sharing intelligence among the intelligence agencies and law enforcement adequate? Is intelligence shared at the right time, and with the right people? Is there a joint strategy among the relevant agencies as to how an investigation should be taken forward? How is consensus achieved, or is one person or one agency the lead decision maker? If so, does everyone know and accept that?

Third, are we making full use of the technology that is now available to us? Intelligence gathering, protective security, investigations and manhunts are all, in the 21st century, dependent on the imaginative use of technology. To take just one example, vehicle number plate recognition systems can help enormously at every stage of the counter-terrorist cycle. They can be used to

IF ALLAH WANTS, I'LL bomb the market where my mother buys vegetables. She will be sent to paradise.

ZIA-UR REHMAN
ACCUSED OF 2008
DELHI SERIAL BLASTS

Cross FIRE

OCT 12, 2000 A suicide attack by an explosive-laden Al Qaeda boat kills 17 US sailors in the *USS Cole*. An attack that cost \$10,000 causes damage worth \$240 million.

SEPT 11, 2001 Three hijacked planes in the US destroy the WTC and damage the Pentagon, killing 2,976 persons.

DEC 13, 2001 Joint strike by LeT and Hizbul Mujahideen on Parliament is foiled but it nearly brings India and Pakistan to war.

MARCH 20, 2003 US-led coalition invades



Iraq on the pretext of securing WMDs.

JULY 7, 2005 Suicide attack on the London underground by Pak-origin Britons kills 52.

NOV 26, 2008 Ten LeT gunmen kill 165 in Mumbai in the largest attack of its kind.